# Chapter 32

# *Tanaa* – Fishing in a group during low tide

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Figure 1: *Tanaa* – Fishing in a group during low tide

(1) *Enaa kahi vahutate ni nom a vagana vai to dao raara a ta Teapu bona tanaa.*
I am going to tell you a story about the fishing that we Teop people call *tanaa*.

(2) *Bea ta Teapu tau nao tea tanaa, eori repaa dee bona maa kave teori tea masi vai to dao raara bono pasu masi.*
When the Teop people are about to do the *tanaa*, they take their nets to the reef during the low tide that we call *pasu masi* 'first low tide in the morning'.

(3) *A masi bona na tavutavusu nana teo pasu nubunubu be boobon vakisi nana.*
This low tide appears in the very early morning when it is still dark.

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| (4) | *Tea matana takaha, a ta vaan repaa vaon bona maa kave teori tea maa sinivi,* | At the beginning of dawn, the people load their nets into the canoes, |
| (5) | *eori repaa hua vo tea hoa, ei beo puhana mei batana tea masi gunaha.* | and then they paddle to the passage before the tide has ebbed down. |
| (6) | *Beori suguna, eori repaa nao busu vatanaa pina ni bona hoa.* | When they have arrived, they will go and throw their nets in a row, thus blocking the passage. |
| (7) | *Ei vira vakavara ni rori bono kave, eori repaa sun teebona.* | Now when having dropped all the nets, they stand there. |
| (8) | *Eori repaa vararana pina naori murina maa kave beori vahakaa pina batari.* | They will line up making a blockade behind the nets, while beating the water and blocking the passage. |
| (9) | *Vahakaa rori bea iana nomaa nana, ei kou na gunaha maari tea hoa ore paa ma ona rori tea kave.* | They are beating the water while the fish are coming, and now they are coming down the passage and then get trapped in the nets. |
| (10) | *Ei be ona, sa antee vaha haari tea nao, pasi topo koa nom komana kave.* | When they are trapped, they cannot go away, but will just be stuck in the nets. |
| (11) | *Bea masi masi maa, ei be gunaha rakaha,* | When the sea is at low tide, when it has completely gone down, |
| (12) | *a tavaan repaa taneo tea pute bona iana komana kave* | the people start pulling the fish out of the nets |
| (13) | *to paa hapusu vaevuru.* | that are already full. |
| (14) | *Beori pute vakavara bona iana vai to tei nana komana kave,* | When they have finished pulling out the fish that are in the nets, |
| (15) | *eori repaa kao hovo pete komana kopua, eori repaa tahi bona iana vai to paa pinou ei komana kopua bona.* | they will also wade through the pools in the lagoon and spear the fish that have been trapped in this lagoon. |
| (16) | *Beori vagana vamatamataa rakaha bari, be kavara rakaha,* | When they have indeed fished every fish, |
| (17) | *eori repaa vaahae vahaa bona maa kave vo teo sinivi,* | they will load the nets into the canoes again, |
| (18) | *eori repaa voosu vahaa vo vaan mi bono sinivi iana.* | and return home with the canoes full of fish. |

(19) *Meha papana rahi batari bona ibun iana to paa tahi vori tea maa makaree teori.*
Others thread the fish that they have speared with their fishing spears on strings.

(20) *Eve o si vahutate no matapaku vaa tea tanaa ei teo kaku vagana vaa Teapu.*
This is the little story of the practice of *tanaa*, this is a type of fishing in the Teop area.

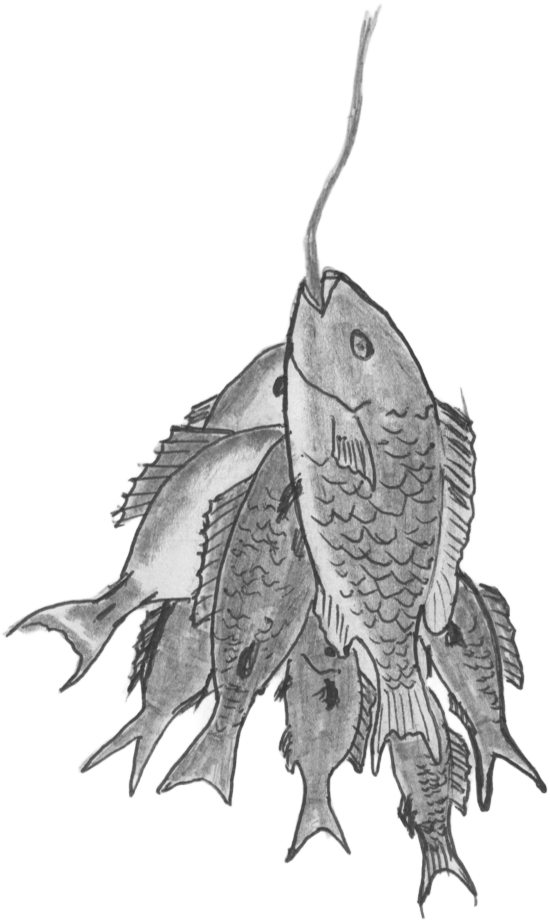


Figure 2: *Ibun iana* – Fish threaded on a string